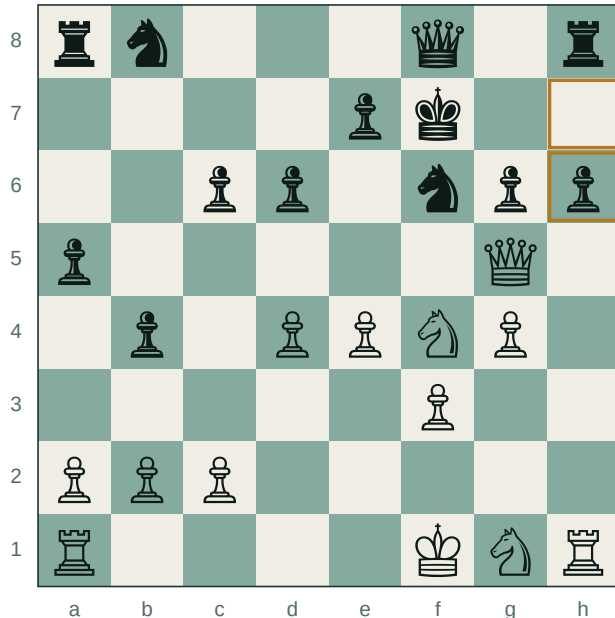


# Mate in one: White, move 18

Mate in one

White to move



Previous move: 17...h6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 18. Qxg6#

**18.Qxg6#** Mate: queen on g6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

### CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A checking piece next to the king must be protected unless the king cannot capture it for another legal reason.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Checkmate is a complete restriction of the enemy king. Find a legal check, then prove there is no king escape, capture of the checker, or interposition.

### HOW TO LOOK

Inspect the king's flight squares before choosing a check. A protected queen or a distant rook may cover the last escape in different ways.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.